thereafter escape; it is lost from our Universe, a loss that poses a severe challenge to physicists' notions about the conservation of mass and energy.

"There is a curious parallel between the histories of black holes and continental drift [the relative drifting motion of the Earth's continents]," Israel writes. "Evidence for both was already non-ignorable by 1916, but both ideas were stopped in their tracks for half a century by a resistance bordering on the irrational. I believe the underlying psychological reason was the same in both cases. Another coincidence: resistance to both began to crumble around 1960. Of course, both fields [astrophysics and geophysics] benefitted from postwar technological developments. But it is nonetheless interesting that this was the moment when the Soviet H-bomb and Sputnik swept away the notion of Western science as engraved in stone and beyond challenge, and, perhaps, instilled the suspicion that there might be more in heaven and earth than Western science was prepared to dream of."

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1. Chapter 10.

2. Figure 1.3, and the lessons of the tale of Mledina and Serona in Chapter 2.